

projects option lets developers reuse code between JVM and JavaScript, for which the code is first placed in a common module.

In addition to the option to reuse code, Kotlin 1.2 beta produces the code for both common and platform-specific parts during the compilation of the project. There is also a way for developers to express dependencies of common



code on platform-specific parts via expected and actual declarations. If the declaration specifies an API, you need to type the alias that refers to an existing implementation of the API in an external library.

The standard library of Kotlin 1.2 features a `kotlin.math` package for mathematical operations in cross-platform code. The math package also

offers better precision for math polyfills for JavaScript.

It is worth noting the compatibility with Java 9 module forest split packages in the new version. This version also removes the deprecated declarations in the `kotlin.reflect` package from the `kotlin-reflect` library.

Kotlin 1.2 also supports an array of literals in annotations and simplifies coding. The new version uses a more consistent syntax.

Oracle leverages open source to develop enterprise-focused blockchain technology

Oracle has finally planned to enter the growing blockchain space by launching its enterprise-centric Oracle BlockChain Cloud Service. The new distributed ledger cloud platform is based on the open source Hyperledger Fabric project, which has been hosted by the Linux Foundation and receives contributions from a group of companies, including Oracle.

"Oracle Blockchain Cloud Service provides enterprise-grade blockchain capabilities and is able to accelerate innovation for on-premise ERP, cloud-based SaaS (Software-as-a-Service)

and PaaS (platform-as-a-service) customers," said Amit Zavery, senior vice president, Oracle Cloud Platform.

The new blockchain platform is a part of Oracle Cloud Platform — touted to deliver enterprise-grade resilience, scalability and security. It also helps enterprise customers streamline operations and expand their market reach by using open source developments and maintaining open standards.

Oracle has developed an applications integration toolkit that comes with integrated applications, sample code, templates and design patterns to help enterprises rapidly deploy blockchain applications to Oracle SaaS and on-premise application suites. The platform also works with real-time information-sharing across existing Oracle ERP Cloud, Oracle SCM Cloud, Netsuite SuiteCloud Platform or custom blockchain application integration.

There is REST API support to let enterprises invoke blockchain services directly or with some pre-built integrations from Oracle Cloud. Oracle has also provided an API management service to enable easy app development in the cloud or on-premise.

Kubernetes 1.8 is all about enhancing security

Kubernetes 1.8 is now out with the prime focus on enhancing its security. The new version upgrades the existing networking support and includes role-based features to deliver a more secure experience.

First in the list of new features in Kubernetes 1.8 is role-based access control (RBAC) that lets an admin define access permissions to various resources. RBAC comes with permission access for resources like pods and secrets that can be granted to one or more users.

The orchestration framework already included a provision for networking. But with the new version, developers have



been provided beta support for filtering outbound traffic as well. However, the beta package limits filtering in both directions, and only supports some destination ports and peers at the initial stage.

The Google team behind Kubernetes has upgraded the automatic TLS certificate rotation for Kubelet to beta. This helps to automatically generate unique certifications for Kubelet when a current one expires. The latest version promotes auditing features from the alpha to the beta stage. This includes formatting tools for audit logs and features to control users of each element of the cluster.

Another feature that has been promoted from alpha to beta is the set of workload APIs. This provides a way to orchestrate applications based on their overall behaviour. Workload APIs can also be used to monitor the production status.

You can find the latest Kubernetes release on its official GitHub page.

